

HABBINSON

PERSONALITY & ENTREPRENEURSHIP SCHOOL



— PARENT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

4 things that actually help a child who stammers

Worried about a child who stammers? Hrithik Roshan stammered as a kid too. Here's what helps a stuttering child speak with confidence — and what to avoid.

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THE CHALLENGE PARENTS FACE

Your child gets stuck on a word. The first sound repeats, the face tightens, and your heart sinks a little. You want to jump in and finish it for them. If you have a child who stammers, you know that ache — the worry that this will hold them back forever. It won't. Here's why.

— THE 30-SECOND ANSWER

4 things that actually help a child who stammers

QUICK ANSWER

What is stuttering? Stuttering (or stammering) is when the flow of speech is broken by repeated sounds ('b-b-ball'), stretched sounds, or blocks where a word won't come out. It is not caused by nervousness or low intelligence. It's a difference in how speech is coordinated — and with the right support, most children speak more fluently over time.

DO THIS

4 things that actually help a child who stammers

Work through these in order. Small, consistent reps beat one big push.

1**Slow your own speech**

Speak to them in an unhurried way with easy pauses. Children copy your pace, not your instructions.

2**Wait a beat before you reply**

A second or two of silence after they finish tells them there's no rush.

3**Ask fewer questions; comment more**

Kids speak more freely sharing their own ideas than being quizzed. Say 'That sounds fun' instead of 'And then what?'

4**Give daily calm talk-time**

A few minutes of full attention where they lead the play and you listen, relaxed, builds safety — and fluency follows safety.

— KEEP AN EYE OUT

What NOT to do when your child stammers

- ✓ Don't say 'slow down' or 'start again.' It tells the child their speech is wrong and adds pressure.
- ✓ Don't finish their sentences. Let them land the word themselves — it builds confidence, not dependence.
- ✓ Don't rush them. A child who feels hurried stammers more, not less.
- ✓ Don't make it a big deal in front of others. Quiet acceptance does more than any correction.

— COMMON QUESTIONS

Quick answers for parents

Is it normal for my young child to stammer?

Often, yes. Many children between two and five have a phase of bumpy, repeated speech as their ideas outrun their mouths, and a lot grow out of it. Stay calm and patient. If it's frequent, lasts beyond a few months, or comes with visible struggle, check in with a speech-language pathologist.

Should I tell my child who stammers to slow down?

No. 'Slow down' or 'start again' tells your child their speech is wrong and adds pressure, which usually makes stammering worse. Instead, slow your own speech and pause before replying. Children copy your relaxed pace far more than they follow the instruction.

What causes stuttering in children?

Stuttering is a difference in how speech is coordinated — not a result of nervousness, fear, or low intelligence. It often runs in families. What surrounds it matters most: pressure tends to increase it, while calm, patient, unhurried listening tends to reduce it.

Will my child grow out of stammering?

Many children do, especially with calm support at home and early help when needed. Even when some stammering remains, children can absolutely become confident, capable speakers. The aim is a child who feels safe to keep talking, not flawless fluency by a deadline.

How can I build my stammering child's confidence?

Protect their willingness to speak. Don't finish their words, don't rush them, and don't make it a big deal in front of others. Give daily calm talk-time where they lead and you listen. Confidence grows when a child feels heard exactly as they are.

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